



Research Examines the Role of Building Byelaws in Architectural Education



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Pune, Maharashtra, 2024: A research study titled "The Role of Bylaws in Architectural Pedagogy" by Ar. Atharvi Paras Netragaonkar, Architect and Urban Planner, has highlighted the growing importance of building regulations as educational tools within architectural training.

The study explores whether building bylaws should be viewed solely as regulatory requirements or as instruments that can positively influence design thinking and professional preparedness among architecture students. Conducted through a review of academic literature and an analysis of housing studio projects in colleges affiliated with Savitribai Phule Pune University (SPPU), the research examines how students engage with development control regulations during the design process.

The findings suggest that when introduced effectively, regulations such as Floor Space Index (FSI), setbacks, parking provisions, and open-space requirements can support rather than restrict creativity. The study notes that understanding these parameters helps students develop practical, context-responsive, and sustainable design solutions while preparing them for the realities of professional practice.

The research further emphasizes that the challenge lies not in the regulations themselves but in the way they are incorporated into architectural education. It advocates a balanced approach where students are gradually introduced to increasing levels of regulatory complexity as their academic projects evolve.

Published in 2024, the study contributes to ongoing discussions on strengthening architectural pedagogy and bridging the gap between academic learning and professional practice. The research concludes that building bylaws should be regarded not merely as compliance mechanisms but as valuable design tools that encourage responsible and informed architectural decision-making.

The project reflects a vision of public space that celebrates the values of dedication, leadership, and sacrifice. Through its carefully planned landscape and community-oriented design, the garden offers visitors an opportunity to engage with nature while remembering the contributions of an individual whose commitment to public service continues to inspire generations.

For Shilpi Architects and Planners, the project represents a meaningful contribution to the city's growing network of public spaces. By combining functionality, accessibility, and cultural significance, Late Shri Ashok Kamte Udyan demonstrates how urban landscapes can become places of remembrance and community engagement.

As a landmark civic space, the garden stands as a lasting tribute to Late Shri Ashok Kamte's legacy while reinforcing the importance of creating public environments that foster connection, reflection, and civic pride.